2.26 Death and the Grieving Family*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I cannot believe he is gone." **Objective** • Crying • In shock	**ACTUAL** Impaired psychological comfort related to the death of a family member as evidenced by crying and expressions of disbelief.	• The family can grieve in a supportive setting.	• Offer a private room. • Allow time with the person who has died. • Refer to the deceased by name. • Respect cultural and religious practices.	• Outcome reached when the family express their feelings openly.
Subjective • "We do not know what to do now." **Objective** • Unsure of procedures • Repeatedly ask what to do next	**ACTUAL** Disrupted family interaction patterns related to the death of a family member as evidenced by confusion about next steps.	• Before leaving, the family can state the next steps.	• Explain release of the body and issue of the death certificate. • Provide written information and telephone numbers. • Involve the social worker if needed. • Respect religious requirements on the timing of burial.	• Considered met when the family understand what comes next.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Sudden death • Little family support	**RISK** Risk for maladaptive grieving as evidenced by risk factors: unexpected death and insufficient social support.	• Before leaving, the family identify at least two sources of support.	• Assess the support available to them. • Give information about bereavement services. • Invite them to contact the unit later with questions.	• Goal reached when sources of support are named.

* **References for this care plan:** [17], [35], [48], [110]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.